https://doi.org/10.37187/gjoes.1219.0104.01
e-ISSN: 2682-7662, Volume 01, Issue 04, Pages 298-301, December 2019
EDITORIAL

Guidelines for writing an article

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Abstract

Every new writer faces the problem of right directions in writing research papers. Many researchers cannot start writing because they do not have a right starting point, or they do not know how to write an article. I have tried to simplify the process of writing a research article by providing a step wise guide. I have used some sources which are cited here; (Crack, Grieves, & Lown, 2011; Farooq et al., 2019; Henningsen, 2015; Jindrich, 2018; Springer, 2019).

Five Ws and a How

What?
It is necessary to be clear on what you want to study. Only you can help yourself to be clear with it.
Identify your key interests having logical reasons.
Why?
Identify your research problem.
Why do you need to do it?
Why your research is important?
Who?
Who is suffering from this problem?
Who will benefit from your results and how?
When?
Time period you want to use for your data collection.
Where?
Select a location (a country or a region).
Who are your respondents?
Why these respondents?
How?
Identify key journals regarding your research interests. Four to Six journals should be enough.
Identify top researchers in your area of research to read their work.
Read articles related to your research area from those selected journals.
Read articles published within last 10 years. Also read important articles no matter when they were published.

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Select a target journal you want to write for.
Identify research gap.
Identify research objectives and questions.
Draw general hypotheses.
Identify the philosophy of your research.
Follow a research design.
Structure your manuscript according to the instructions provided by the target journal. If no specific instructions are provided, then it would be better to follow the pattern of previous papers published in that selected journal.
Perform a qualitative or quantitative or mixed methods study. Explain why.
Specify data collection methods.
Specify data analysis methods and perform data analysis.
Discuss your results and compare them with previous studies. Elaborate why your results are same or otherwise.
Provide logical reasons with references supporting every step you take in your research. Sometimes one good reference is enough to support your argument.

Commonly used format for manuscript writing

Title

- It should contain main topics
- Should show the importance of the study
- Should be concise and attractive

e.g. "Service Quality Analysis of Private Universities Libraries in Malaysia in The Era of Transformative Marketing"

Abstract

- It should provide summary of the study
- Should present research methodology, results and beneficiaries of the study

e.g. This study aims to investigate and measure the satisfaction of students with the libraries' services of Malaysian Universities. To achieve this, a self-administered questionnaire was distributed among the students of private Universities. The survey instrument was adapted from Parasuraman's traditional SERVQUAL model. In this research total of 287 responses were collected from the users of libraries. After analysis of data with SPSS and Smart PLS 3, it has been concluded that the Service Quality dimension "Tangibles" is the most important factor in the satisfaction of the users. SERVQUAL components' reliability also has a significant positive impact on student's satisfaction. Compared to previous studies which say empathy has a positive relationship with the students' satisfaction we have found that the responsiveness plays a mediating role between empathy and customer satisfaction. If employees are empathic, their responsiveness increases and ultimately students become satisfied with the library services. This study is beneficial for the librarians and decision makers of the Universities. Library building, seating arrangement, printing and scanning facilities, and e-library content should be top priorities of all the management to increase library usage and keep the students satisfied. Library management

https://doi.org/10.37187/gjoes.1219.0104.01
should also focus on responding to student queries on a priority basis to improve the responsiveness which has a direct relationship with the students' satisfaction.

Introduction, Methods and Results

Introduction

- Background information
- Reasons to study
- What question/problem was studied
- Citations
  - Well balanced (favorable and unfavorable results)
  - Current
  - Relevant
- Purpose of the study
  - A gap
  - New population
- Statement of study aims

Materials and Methods

- Explain different methodologies
- What you did
- Established methods
- Methods applied by you
- Explain all statistical test and parameters

Results

- Only results, no interpretation or discussion
- Subheadings to separate results of different experiments
- Most important results first
- Provide tables and figures if necessary to summarize the results

Discussion and Conclusions (what do your results mean?)

- Compare consistency of results with other studies
- Mention inconclusive results which may need additional experiments
- Limitations
- How could your findings be applied?
- How your results extend the findings of previous studies?
- Suggest future studies
- State your main conclusion once again

Acknowledgements

- Thank all those who helped for the research but did not qualify for authorship

References

- Provide references by using a reference manager (use referencing style as per the requirement of the journal)
- Reference Managers
  - BibTex
  - EndNote

- Mendeley
- Zotero

References

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